

The CAT Exam Pattern 2025 has been officially released by IIM Kozhikode, and there are few changes in the paper structure in CAT 2025. The CAT 2025 will be held on 30 November 2025 as a computer based test (CBT) in a single shift .

You will have to attempt 68 questions in 120 minutes, combining both MCQs and TITA (Type In The Answer) questions divided into 3 sections: Verbal Ability & Reading Comprehension (VARC), Data Interpretation & Logical Reasoning (DILR), and Quantitative Ability (QA).

Verbal Ability & Reading Comprehension (VARC): 24 questions in 40 minutes

Data Interpretation & Logical Reasoning (DILR): 22 questions in 40 minutes

Quantitative Ability (QA): 22 questions in 40 minutes

As per the CAT Marking Scheme, MCQs give +3 for a correct answer and –1 for a wrong answer while TITA questions don't have negative marking.

Key Summary

VARC: 24 questions, 65–70% Reading Comprehension; TITA increased in paragraph completion and summaries; para-jumbles removed.

DILR: 22 questions (raised from 20); 5 sets, 2 sets of 5 questions, 3 sets of 4 questions.

QA: 22 questions, 30–35% TITA, majority in Arithmetic and Modern Math.

Total Duration: 120 minutes, 40 minutes per section (order of the sections is fixed as VARC, DILR, QA; no switching allowed). PwD candidates get 160 minutes.

Total Questions: The total number of questions has been increased to 68 from 66.

Marking Scheme: 3 marks will be awarded for each correct answer, –1 for incorrect MCQs, and there will be no negative marking for TITA.

MCQ vs TITA: The CAT 2025 will have around 49 MCQs and 19 TITA questions, a slight increase in the number of TITA questions as compared to previous years.

Maximum Marks: The CAT 2025 will be of 204 marks (increased from 198 marks in CAT 2024).

What is the pattern of a CAT exam?

The CAT Exam Pattern 2025 will be set by IIM Kozhikode by Prof. Ram Kumar P.N.

In CAT 2025, you will have a computer - based exam with 68 questions, a total of 204 marks.

The CAT exam pattern will be divided in 3 sections: VARC, DILR, and QA..

In CAT 2025 exam each section will have 40 minutes a fixed time limit to attempt.

The CAT exam will have both MCQs and TITA questions, with a marking scheme of +3 for a correct answer, –1 for incorrect MCQs, and no negative marking for TITA.

Feature	Details
Exam Name	Common Admission Test (CAT) 2025
Mode	Computer-Based Test (CBT)
Total Duration	120 minutes (2 hours)
Number of Sections	3
Sectional Time Limit	40 minutes per section (auto switch)

Total Questions	68
Question Types	MCQs & TITA (Type In The Answer)
Marking Scheme	+3 for correct, -1 for incorrect MCQ, 0 for TITA
Language of Exam	English
Expected Exam Date	November 30, 2025 (Tentative)
Total Marks	204

Ques. How many non-MCQ questions will I face in each section?

Ans. In the CAT 2025, **you can expect around 20 non-MCQ (TITA) questions** overall and from as per the sections:

From VARC, you can expect around 2 non-MCQ questions, around 10 in the DILR section, and 8 in QA section.

That is roughly **30% of the paper**, which means you can attempt 30% of the CAT exam safely, as non-MCQs carry no negative marking, so you should try to attempt all of them.

Ques. If I skip many MCQs (to avoid negative marking) and focus more on TITA, is that optimal?

Ans. Yes, it is partially optimal to skip some MCQs, especially the risky ones, and focus on non-MCQs to avoid negative marking. **But skipping “many MCQs” can cost you the potential marks.** In CAT 2024, there were a total of around 46 MCQs and 20 non-MCQs, **so if you attempt only non-MCQs correctly (say all 20 correctly), that will give you $20 \times 3 = 60$ marks**, which is not sufficient to secure the IIMs.

So, completely skipping the MCQs is insufficient for top percentiles. Rather than skipping the MCQs to avoid negative marking, **you can focus on the MCQs that are comparatively easier by practicing the mock tests and analysing your weak areas.**

Ques. Will the sectional difficulty vary across slots and how does that affect scoring?

Ans. Yes, sectional difficulty is expected to vary across slots, and that variation can affect how raw scores translate to percentiles/ranks.

For CAT 2024, the cutoff for the top percentile varied slightly across the slots: 99.9 percentile raw marks:

To score 99%ile, the raw score requirement differs by slot: **91 in Slot 1, 85 in Slot 2, and 88 in Slot 3, along with the sectional cutoff for CAT 2024**

- **VARC: 99%ile ~ 41**
- **DILR: 99%ile ~ 38**
- **QA: 99%ile ~ 33**

Percentile	Slot-1 overall	Slot-2 overall	Slot-3 overall
------------	----------------	----------------	----------------

100%ile	150	140	140
99.5%ile	97	95	96
99%ile	91	85	88
98%ile	80	74	77
95%ile	67	62	65
90%ile	55	50	53

Changes in the CAT Exam Pattern 2025

- **Total Question:** The number of questions has increased to 68 from 66 in 2024, with 2 additional questions in DILR.
- **TITA Questions:** In the CAT 2025 exam, it is expected that TITA questions will rise, especially in QA, by 30–35%, with no negative marking.
- **Sectional Distribution:** The VARC will have 20 MCQs & 4 TITA, DILR will have 12–14 MCQs & 6–8 TITA, and QA will have 15–16 MCQs & 6–7 TITA.
- **DILR Structure:** There will be a total of 22 questions (an additional 2 questions) with 3 sets of 4 and 2 sets of 5 questions.
- **CAT Marking Scheme:** +3 marks will be awarded for each correct answer, -1 for each incorrect answer, and no negative marks for TITA in 40 minutes per section.
- **Difficulty and Percentile:** The CAT 2024 was moderate, with Slot 1 being the easiest and Slot 3 being the toughest. For CAT 2025, to achieve 90 percentile, 47–51 marks are required, and for the 95th percentile, around 58-61 marks.

Component	CAT 2024 Pattern	CAT 2025 (Expected)	What Changed
Total Questions	66	68	+2 questions added (in DILR)
Sections	3 (VARC, DILR, QA)	Same	No change
Section-wise Qs	VARC: 24 DILR: 20 QA: 22	VARC: 24 DILR: 22 QA: 22	+2 Qs in DILR
Total Marks	198	204	Total marks have been changed as the number of questions are increased

TITA Count	~20 (30%)	~22–24 (32–35%)	Slight increase in TITA questions
Duration	120 minutes (40 min/section)	Same	No change
DILR Structure	4 sets × 5 Qs (20 Qs total)	3 sets × 4 Qs + 2 sets × 5 Qs = 22 Qs	New structure introduced
Question Types	MCQ & TITA	MCQ & TITA	No change, but TITA share increased
Marking Scheme	+3 for correct–1 for wrong MCQ 0 for TITA	Same	No change
Sectional Order	Fixed (VARC → DILR → QA)	Same	No change
Adaptive Format	No	No	Confirmed non-adaptive in 2025
Difficulty Level	Moderate	Moderate (slot-dependent)	Slot 1 easier, Slot 3 tougher (as per CAT 2024)
Cut-off Trend	90 th ile ≈ 45–48 marks	90 th ile ≈ 48–52 marks (expected)	Slight increase expected due to easier QA & DILR

Ques. Will the total number of questions change (versus CAT 2024)?

Ans. The total number of questions is expected to change from 66 to 68, with an increase of 2 questions in DILR sections, making a total of 22 questions.

Ques. Will the mix of MCQ / non-MCQ (TITA) questions change?

Ans. Yes, there is a possibility that questions in CAT will be a mix of MCQ vs non-MCQ (TITA) could change. In the CAT 2025 expected exam pattern, there can be 48 MCQs with 20 non-MCQs (around 70/30 split).

According to the mock tests and analysis, the CAT 2025 will have a similar section-wise MCQ / non-MCQ splits (e.g., VARC: 22 MCQ + 2 TITA, DILR: 12 MCQ + 10 TITA, QA: 14 MCQ + 8 TITA) in their expected pattern.

Ques. Will all questions have negative marking in 2025?

Ans. No, not all questions in the CAT 2025 will have negative marking, as per the marking scheme of the CAT 2025:

MCQs: Each correct answer awards **+3 marks**, **-1 mark** for each incorrect answer.

TITA Questions: These questions require candidates to type in their answers without provided options. For TITA questions:

- **No negative marking** for incorrect answers.
- **No marks deducted** for unanswered questions.
- **+3 marks** for correct answers.

Ques. Will Para Jumbles / Grammar / New question types return?

Ans. Yes, Para Jumbles / Grammar / New question types can return in the CAT 2025, especially in the VARC (Verbal Ability and Reading Comprehension) section.

As the latest CAT exam pattern has not been released yet, the VARC section in CAT 2025 is anticipated to consist of 24 questions, distributed as follows:

Reading Comprehension (RC): 16 questions (4 passages × 4 questions each)

Verbal Ability (VA): 8 questions, including:

- **Para Summary:** 3 questions
- **Para Insertion:** 3 questions
- **Odd Sentence Out:** 2 questions

CAT 2025 Section-Wise User Expectations for Difficulty

The section-wise difficulty expectations for CAT 2025 show a balanced yet challenging paper, with the VARC section expected to be the toughest section.

- The previous year's test takers anticipated Moderate to High difficulty in VARC, emphasizing the need for strong comprehension and inference skills.
- The DILR is expected to remain moderate, with around 20 questions, so practicing puzzles and learning to choose the right sets will be important.
- The QA section should be moderate, with concepts similar to previous years.

Section	Expected Difficulty Level	User Insights/Tips
VARC	Moderate to High	"VARC might be on the higher side"; focus on comprehension
DILR	Moderate	"Will LRDI remain 20 questions as last year?"; practice puzzles cautiously
QA	Moderate	Standard; no major shifts noted

CAT 2025 Exam Shifts and Reporting

The CAT 2025 exam will be conducted in three shifts, ensuring the smooth conduct across the exam day.

- Shift 1 (8:30–10:30 AM), the candidates are expected to report to the exam centre by 7:30 AM to complete verification comfortably.
- For the shift 2 (12:30–2:30 PM), the candidates are advised to report by 11:30 AM to the exam centre.
- Shift 3 (4:30–6:30 PM), the evening shift can affect the focus due to the fatigueness. In this shift, the candidates should report to the centre by 3:30 PM.

Shift	Exam Time Slot	Reporting Time (Approx.)	User Notes
Shift 1	8:30 AM - 10:30 AM	7:30 AM	Morning slot; arrive early for checks

Shift 2	12:30 PM - 2:30 PM	11:30 AM	Lunch break; monitor for crowds
Shift 3	4:30 PM - 6:30 PM	3:30 PM	Evening, potential fatigue factor

Section-wise CAT 2025 Exam Pattern

The CAT 2025 exam will be divided into 3 sections: Verbal Ability & Reading Comprehension (VARC), Data Interpretation & Logical Reasoning (DILR), and Quantitative Aptitude (QA). Each section has 40 minutes, making a total of 204 marks with 68 questions.

CAT VARC Exam Pattern 2025

- The CAT Exam Pattern of VARC 2025 is heavily dominated by Reading Comprehensions, with 16 questions out of 24, making it 66–67% weightage.
- The remaining 8 VARC questions (33-34% weightage), include Para Jumbles, Para Summary, and Odd-Sentence-Out, mostly TITA type with no negative marking.
- With 21 MCQs and only 2 TITA questions, with 3 marks for correct MCQs and -1 for incorrect answer.

Feature	Details
Total Questions	24
Total Marks	72
Section Time	40 minutes
MCQs (approx.)	21
TITA (approx.)	2 (no negative marking)
Reading Comprehension	~16 questions (~66–67%)
Verbal Ability	~8 questions (~33–34%)

CAT DILR Exam Pattern 2025

- The DILR Section in the CAT Exam pattern 2025 has 22 questions with a total of 66 marks in 40 minutes.
- There will be around 12 MCQs carrying negative marking of -1 and around 10 TITA-type questions with no penalty.
- This is structured in 3 sets of 4 questions each and 2 sets of 5 questions each.

Feature	Details
Total Questions	22

Total Marks	66 (22 × 3 marks each)
Section Time	40 minutes
MCQs (approx.)	12 MCQs
TITA (approx.)	10 TITA questions (no negative marking)
Set Structure	Usually in sets (e.g., 3 sets of 4 Qs and 2 sets of 5 Qs)

CAT Exam Pattern QA 2025

- As per the CAT exam pattern in QA section, there will be 22 questions, making a total of 66 marks in 40 minutes fixed time limit.
- There will be around 14 MCQs with -1 for incorrect answers and around 8 TITA with no negative marking.

Feature	Details
Total Questions	22
Total Marks	66 (22 × 3 marks each)
Section Time	40 minutes
MCQs (approx.)	~14 MCQs
TITA (approx.)	~8 TITA questions (no negative marking)

Ques. How can I improve my performance in the QA section?

Ans. Improving your performance in the Quantitative Ability (QA) section of the CAT exam requires a strategic approach and building a strong foundation by practicing the questions daily while managing the time efficiently.

- Understand the QA syllabus thoroughly: Arithmetic, Algebra, Number Systems, Geometry, and Modern Math.
- Focus on high-weightage topics, Arithmetic (Time & Work, Percentages, Profit & Loss), Algebra (Linear & Quadratic Equations), and Geometry basics.
- You should solve a variety of problems daily from each topic and take timed mock tests to simulate the exam conditions.

Ques. What is the order of sections in the CAT exam?

Ans. In the CAT 2025 exam the fixed order of sections will be as follows:

- **Verbal Ability and Reading Comprehension (VARC)**
- **Data Interpretation and Logical Reasoning (DILR)**

- **Quantitative Ability (QA)**

There each section will be an allotted time of 40 minutes, and candidates will not be allowed to switch between the sections during the CAT 2025.

Ques. What are the marks of the CAT exam section-wise?

Ans. The CAT 2025 exam is expected to have a total of 68 questions and a maximum score of 204 marks, where 3 marks will be awarded for each correct answer, -1 for each incorrect MCQ, and TITA questions will have no negative marking.

So, the CAT 2025 section-wise marks distribution will be:

- **The VARC will have a total of 24 questions** with 72 total marks.
- **DILR and QA will have 22 questions each**, making a total of 66 marks for each section.

Ques. Is 70 a good score in CAT?

Ans. A score of 70 marks in the CAT exam is considered above average, which translates to a 95th percentile, while top IIMs will require even higher marks, but the other esteemed institutes like IIM Lucknow, IIM Kozhikode, SPJIMR, and MDI Gurgaon are expected to accept candidates with scores around 70.

Ques. Which is the easiest section in CAT?

Ans. As per the CAT 2024 exam, the Quantitative Ability (QA) section was considered as the easiest among the 3 sections.

- **In CAT 2024 slot 1**, the QA section was considered the most easy, with many candidates attempting 14–15 questions comfortably.
- **In Slots 2 and 3**, QA was the easiest among all three slots, with questions being simpler compared to previous years.

Section	Difficulty Level (CAT 2024)
VARC	Moderate
DILR	Moderate to Tough
QA	Easy

Ques. How many questions to attempt in CAT in each section?

Ans. To score 99 percentile in the CAT exam, it is recommended from previous years' exams and experts that **you attempt around 50–55 questions correctly out of the total 68**, with an accuracy rate of 85% to 90%. And approximately 15–17 correct answers per section.

CAT Total Marks 2025

The total exam marks in CAT 2025 carry 204 marks across 68 questions, maintaining the same marking scheme as 2024.

- The VARC will have 24 questions with a total marks of 72, which is 35% of the total marks in CAT 2025
- Both DILR and QA have 22 questions making a total of 66 marks each and around 32% weightage each of the CAT 2025.

Section	Number of Questions	Marks per Section
---------	---------------------	-------------------

VARC	24	72 (24 × 3)
DILR	22	66 (22 × 3)
QA	22	66 (22 × 3)
Total	68	204

CAT Marking Scheme 2025

- **As per the CAT Marking Scheme**, +3 for correct answers; –1 for wrong MCQs; no negative marking for TITA or skipped questions.
- **Total Marks** of CAT 2025 are, 204 (higher than 198 in CAT 2024).
- **TITA-type questions have an advantage, as there will be no negative marking** with around 20–25 TITA Qs (~30–35%) are risk-free, especially in QA which is around ~35%.

Detail	Description
Total Marks	204 (68 questions × 3 marks each)
Marks for Correct Answer	+3 for both MCQs and TITA (Type-In-The-Answer)
Negative Marking	–1 for each incorrect MCQ; no negative marking for TITA or skipped questions
Penalty for Unattempted Questions	None — zero penalty for skipping any question
Purpose of Negative Marking	To discourage random guessing and reward accuracy under pressure

CAT Marking Scheme 2025 Section-wise

- VARC (24 questions with 72 marks) each MCQ carries 3 marks for correct answer, -1 for incorrect answer, while TITA has no penalty for incorrect answer.
- DILR (22 questions with 66 marks) has around 12 MCQs, with +3 for correct answer and -1 for incorrect answer, but around 10 TITA will have no negative marking.
- QA (22 questions with 66 marks) will have 14 MCQs with 3 marks for each correct answer and -1 for each wrong answer, while around 8 TITA with no negative marking.

Section	Total Qs	MCQs (marking scheme)	TITA (marking scheme)	Total Marks
VARC	24	~20 MCQs+3/–1	~4 TITA (no penalty)	72
DILR	22	~12 MCQs+3/–1	~10 TITA (no penalty)	66

QA	22	~14 MCQs+3/-1	~8 TITA (no penalty)	66
Total	68	~46 MCQs	~22 TITA	204

CAT Exam Time Duration

The total CAT exam duration is 120 minutes for general candidates and 160 for PwD candidates.

- There is a fixed Time limit for each sections: VARC, DILR, and QA, exactly 40 minutes are allotted for general category.
- For PwD candidates extra time is allotted i.e, 53 minutes and 20 seconds, maintaining proportional extension across all sections.

CAT Exam Sections	No. of Questions	Time Limit	Time Limit for PwD Students
Verbal Ability and Reading Comprehension (VARC)	24	40 minutes	53 minutes and 20 seconds
Data Interpretation & Logical Reasoning (DILR)	22	40 minutes	53 minutes and 20 seconds
Quantitative Aptitude (QA)	22	40 minutes	53 minutes and 20 seconds
Total	68	120 minutes	160 minutes

CAT Exam Pattern Comparison (2025 vs 2024)

The CAT Exam Pattern 2025 is almost the same as 2024, with just a few changes in DILR and QA.

- The VARC stays the same with 24 questions and mostly MCQs.
- The DILR section will have 2 additional questions, making a total of 22 questions with 3 sets of 4 questions and 2 sets of 5 questions, making it a bit more diverse and tricky.
- The QA Section will also have 22 questions, with a slight rise in the TITA-type questions from around 6 to 8. This shift pushes you to focus more on concepts and calculations.
- Overall, CAT 2025 is expected to bring in more TITA-type questions, to make the CAT exam risk-free attempts, and to score well in the exam.

Section	CAT 2024 Qs	CAT 2025 Qs (Expected)	MCQs (approx.)	TITA (approx.)	Notable Change
VARC	24	24	20	4	No change
DILR	20	22	12	10	New set format: 3×4 Qs + 2×5 Qs

QA	22	22	14	8	Increase in TITA share
----	----	----	----	---	------------------------

Ques. How many CAT attempts are allowed?

Ans. There is no limit to the number of attempts for the CAT exam; you are free to appear for the CAT as many times as you want, provided you meet the eligibility criteria each year.

Ques. Is CAT online or offline?

Ans. The CAT is a computer-based test (CBT), conducted online at the designated exam centers across India. You must visit your assigned exam center on the day of the CAT exam, where they will use a computer to answer the questions.

Ques. Is CAT exam full mcq?

Ans. No, the CAT exam is not fully MCQ-based; the CAT exam includes both Multiple-Choice Questions (MCQs) and Type-in-the-Answer (TITA) questions. The sections will have,

- **VARC (Verbal Ability & Reading Comprehension):** 24 questions, with expected 22 MCQs and 2 TITA-type questions.
- **DILR (Data Interpretation & Logical Reasoning):** 22 questions, including 12 MCQs and 10 TITA-type questions.
- **QA (Quantitative Ability):** 22 questions divided into 14 MCQs and 8 TITA-type questions.

CAT VARC Topics Weightage 2025

- In CAT VARC 2025, RC has the highest weightage of around 66–67% with 16 out of 24 questions, making it most important section for high scores.
- The Verbal Ability section contributes 33% with the remaining 8 questions.
- The Para Jumbles (3 questions, 12.5%), Para Summary (3 questions, 12.5%), and Odd Sentence Out (2 questions, 8%).

Topic	Approx. Questions	Approx.Weightage	Question Type
Reading Comprehension (RC)	16	66–67%	MCQ (passage-based: inference, tone, etc.)
Para Jumbles (VA)	3	12.5%	TITA (sequence arrangement)
Para Summary (VA)	3	12.5%	MCQ (best summary)
Odd Sentence Out (VA)	2	8%	TITA (misfit identification)
Total	24	100%	—

CAT DILR Topics Weightage 2025

- The question from Logical Reasoning (easier) will have around 6 questions contributing 27.3%.
- The Logical Reasoning (moderate to difficult) have about 6 questions (~27.3%), involving medium to tough puzzles, testing deeper reasoning and analytical skills.

- The easier Data Interpretation has 5 questions (~22.7%), straightforward sets requiring quick calculations and interpretation.
- Data Interpretation (moderate) contributes 5 questions (~22.7%), complex DI caselets demanding careful analysis, multiple-step reasoning, and calculation accuracy.

Topic	Approx. Questions	Approx.Weightage	Note
Logical Reasoning (easier)	6	27.3%	Easier LR questions
Logical Reasoning (moderate to difficult)	6	27.3%	Medium to tough LR puzzles
Data Interpretation (easier)	5	22.7%	Straightforward DI sets
Data Interpretation (moderate)	5	22.7%	More complex DI caselets
Total	22	100%	—

CAT QA Topics Weightage 2025

- The Arithmetic section will have 8–10 questions with 36.3% weightage, the highest weighted topic by focusing on percentages, ratios, time-speed-distance, and averages.
- The Algebra will have around 31.8% weightage with 5-7 questions by covering equations, inequalities, and sequences.
- Geometry will contribute 1-3 questions from triangles, circles, and mensuration
- Modern Math will have around 18.1% weightage with 2-4 questions from probability, permutations & combinations.

Topic	Approx. Questions	Weightage	Note
Arithmetic	8–10	~36.3%	High-frequency, fundamental arithmetic topics
Algebra	5–7	~31.8%	Strong presence of equations & inequalities
Geometry	1–3	~12.6%	Occasional geometry/mensuration questions
Modern Math	2–4	~18.1%	Covers probability, permutations, sets, etc.
Total	22	100%	—